

COLD OPEN

INT. ROSEMARYS HOUSE - DAY

JACK and LYNETTE come into the house LAUGHING. They're dressed in nice attire and Lynette has a doggy bag.

LYNETTE

(laughing)

--And then when he spilled the scalding hot soup onto that woman's lap!

JACK

(laughing)

Oh, man!

(calmed down)

I still don't know how you were able to tie that waiter's shoelaces together.

LYNETTE

I was a devious child.

Jack plops onto his couch as Lynette heads into the kitchen.

JACK

This has been one of my better birthdays. Thank you.

Lynette comes into the living room with some gifts.

LYNETTE

It's not over yet!

She places the gifts in Jack's lap.

JACK

Oh, you didn't ha-- I thought the dinner and the waiter embarrassment were my gifts?

LYNETTE

Eh, I spoil you.

Jack opens up the first gift. It's a framed picture of him as a child crying in front of a counter. A giant red stuffed possum is propped up behind said counter. Jack stares at it.

JACK

Wow. Where... where did yo--

LYNETTE

I found it in a photo album in your Mom's room while you were showering.

JACK

Oh, so you rifle through my mother's things while I bathe.

LYNETTE

Do you really expect to leave me alone in this house not look for hidden treasures?

Jack shrugs and nods in agreement.

JACK

Right. Well. What else do we have here?

LYNETTE

Woah woah, you have to tell me the back story here.

Jack SIGHS.

JACK

Yea, this... this was from my seventh birthday, actually. I had the party at that Chuck-E-Cheese knock off in town.

LYNETTE

Petey Possums?

JACK

(chuckles)

Yea. Leave it to Toledo to not have a proper children's entertainment center. Anyways. Are you familiar with that giant red possum that's behind the counter there?

Jack points to the red possum.

LYNETTE

Who isn't? That's basically the pride of Petey himself. It's pretty much unwinnable.

JACK

Yea, well. I tried and I was short about ten thousand tickets.

When I asked my Dad to win it for me... he told me that I have to learn how to be a winner. Then, when I started to cry... he laughed and took this picture to... remind me of my failure.

LYNETTE

Wow. That's... pretty harsh.

JACK

After that day, I vowed to win that thing. One way or another.

LYNETTE

Huh... Did you?

Jack doesn't answer immediately.

JACK

No... no, I didn't.

He stares off into space.

LYNETTE

Jack?

Jack has a thousand-yard stare with a creepy smile on his face.

END OF COLD OPEN

They come in from having dinner. They're laughing. "And when she spilt the scolding hot soup on that old woman's lap!" "Oh, man. This has been quite the birthday. Thank you. They kiss. "It's not over yet." They get settled and Lynette pulls out a couple of gifts. "Open this one first" She hands him a gift for his birthday. It's a picture of him crying at petey possums in a frame. "Where did you find this?" "There's a stack of photo albums in your moms room. Took a gander while you were showering". "Man. This was at that Chuck-e-cheese knock off." "Petey Possums?" "Yea, leave it to Toledo to not even have a proper childrens entertainment center. This was my 7th birthday. My dad took it after I begged him to win me that giant stuffed possum behind me." "Oh yea, I remember that thing. It was impossible to win. You needed, like, ten thousand tickets or something. "Oh, I know. Ever since that day I vowed I'd win that thing and shove it in my Dad's stupid face." "Did you?" "No..." He looks off into the distance. "I didn't" It was taken by his dad. His father made fun of him for not being able to win the stuffed animal and

took that picture as proof of his failure. Jack stares off into space as he talks about how he vowed to win that stuffed animal to prove his dad wrong. He realizes he never won it. Lynette says "You're going to try and get that stuffed animal aren't you?" "No!... no. I'm an adult." *chuckles* He continues to stare off into space. "I'll check what time they open tomorrow."

ACT ONE

INT. CLASSROOM - DAY

Jack comes in with a black eye and tells them about his weekend. He writes on the board how he went to petey possums to try and get the stuffed animal, but the bouncer didn't let him in. "Well. I certainly had an interesting weekend. Lynette came by for my birthday a--" "Oh, happy birthday." "No no. Don't. People shouldn't be congratulated on something that that took little to no effort on their end." All of the students look around. So, we stopped at Petey Possums on Saturday an--" "Why did you go to Petey Possums?" - Marcus. He looks over at Marcus. " GOD DA-- Don't. Ever. Interrupt me again, Marcus. I'm in no mood for your nasally voice today. Now. As I was saying. We went to petey possums to get that Giant red possum that's, surprisingly, still in the exact location. Can't imagine that they clean the thing, but I digress. When I tried to get into the establishment, a brute of a man stopped me and told me I needed a child to get in. We argued and he was much much bigger than me, which is why you see the badass black eye that I'm sporting. Now that you're all caught up, I need one of you guys to pose as my child. Anyone besides Marcus want to volunteer?." Nobody volunteers. Dan Decker looks around and raises his hand. "I'll help you out, Mr. G" "Why, thank you, Dan Decker, but you're all bordering the age range that you would find there and, let's be honest, you look like you'd be hanging out at the mall with the cool kids. No, I'm looking to bring someone who looks a bit more pathetic. Someone who would spend his teenage weekends at Petey Possums. Victor comes in. "Sorry, I'm late. I got caught up in farming my crops in Animal Crossing. Been pulling weeds all morning." Jack looks over and smiles.

The students are sitting quietly in their seats. Jack comes in with a black eye and launches his half eaten apple into the garbage can.

JACK

Alright, everyone, shut up!

The students jump. Jack tosses his lunch onto his desk.

HEATHER
H-how was your weekend, boss?

JACK
Well. as you can see from this shiner
I'm rocking, it wasn't great.

Jack picks up a piece of chalk and draws on the chalkboard.

JACK(CONT'D)
Lynette and I went out to dinner
Friday night for my birthday. Sh--

GRACE
--Oh, happy birthday!

Jack stops.

JACK
No, no. Don't. People shouldn't be
congratulated on something that took
little to no effort on their end.

The students look around, confused. Jack draws on the chalkboard.

JACK(CONT'D)
The gift she gave me reminded me of a
vow I took many years ago. A vow I
plan to fulfill. So we went to Petey
Possums that Saturday a--

MARCUS
--Petey Possums? Why would yo--

JACK
--GOD!

Jack whips around. Marcus jumps back a bit.

JACK(CONT'D)
God dammit, Marcus. Don't you
interrupt me again. I am in no mood to
hear your nasally voice today.

Jack turns back around and continues his drawing.

JACK(CONT'D)
As I was saying. We went to Petey
Possums to win this stuffed red possum
that's, surprisingly, still in the

exact location. Can't imagine that they clean the thing, but I digress. After I entered the establishment, a brute of a man stopped me and told me I needed a child to get in. We argued and instead of using his words, like an adult, he decided to get physical and proceeded to throw a cheap shot directly at my face.

Jack puts the chalk down. Behind him are drawings of stick figures describing the whole scene.

JACK(CONT'D)

Now that you're all caught up, I need one of you guys to pose as my child. Anyone besides Marcus want to volunteer?.

Nobody volunteers. DAN DECKER looks around and raises his hand.

DAN

I'll help you out, Mr. G.

JACK

I appreciate that Dan Decker, but let's be honest, you look like you'd be hanging out at the mall with the cool kids. No, I'm looking to bring someone who looks a bit more pathetic. Someone who would spend his teenage weekends at Petey Possums.

VICTOR barges in.

VICTOR

Sorry, I'm late, Mr. Griffin. I got caught up in farming my crops in Animal Crossing. Been pulling weeds all morning.

Victor chuckles and walks to his seat. Jack smiles.

INT. TEACHERS LOUNGE - DAY

MICHELLE, STEF, MARY, and HELEN sit around the table eating their lunch and conversing.

MARY

When he walked me to my door, he

grabbed my hand and started wiggling his grimy tongue across my fingers and said, "Until next time."

They all shiver in disgust. Helen seems unfazed.

STEF

Girl, you definitely win.

They each hand her a dollar. Mary looks proud.

MARY

What can I say? I attract the abnormal.

HELEN

Yea, I don't know who could top that. I was going to bring up the time I

They look disturbed. Mary slowly slides the cash over to Helen.

MICHELLE

What about Durbin?

They all look over at DURBIN by the coffee machine. He's opening mustard packets and squirting them onto his sandwich.

MICHELLE(CONT'D)

You think he has any bad date stories?

DURBIN squirts some mustard all over his shirt.

MARY

Psh, he'd have to go on dates to have a bad one.

HELEN

Hey, now. That's a little harsh. He's had a lot on his plate since he and the misses split up. He doesn't have time to galavant around the city looking for hussies. He's got a school to run. Not to mention a _____

The teachers look a little sad.

MICHELLE

Aw. I never even thought about that.

STEF

Yea...

Stef turns back to the teachers.

STEF(CONT'D)

We should try and set him up with someone.

Mary raises her eyebrow.

MARY

Uhh. Like who?

STEF

I don't know. We all have single girlfriends. There must be someone who's willing to give him a shot.

MICHELLE

Oh! I have plenty of desperate friends! I'll ask around.

MARY

Good. I don't think I want to subject any of my girlfriends to...

They all look back toward Durbin. He's hunched over and takes a bite of his sandwich. A bunch of it falls onto his plate. A tomato falls on the ground. He looks around, picks it up, and puts it back on his sandwich.

MARY(CONT'D)

That.

HELEN

What? Are you guys too good for the five-second rule?

The three teachers are talking over lunch. Helen is also in on this conversation. One of them is talking about a date they went on. "And then he asked if my vagina had any piercings." They laugh. "Does it?" -weird teacher. They all look at her, confused. They look over at Durbin (who's looking especially pathetic). "When was the last time you think Ralph has had a date?" "I don't think any since him and his wife split up." "That's sad. He should get back into the game. Maybe it'll help him be less..." Durbin's sandwich spills onto himself. "Durbin." "What if we helped him find someone?" "Do you know anyone that would want to date him?" "Um. None that come to mind right now, but I'm sure I could

look through my phone." and agree they should find someone to date him. (Durbin spills some sandwich on himself. He picks it up and eats it)

WHATEVER THE C RUNNER IS

DALE's mopping the bathroom. He's dancing to some toons on his headphones and miming the lyrics into the mop handle. A student comes out of a stall and washes his hands. Dale takes his headphones off.

DALE
Oh, hey there, Franky!

He looks at his watch.

DALE(CONT'D)
I see you're right on schedule for
your twelve-thirty.

Franky seems confused and walks out of the bathroom.

DALE(CONT'D)
Keep up that fiber intake, bud!

Dale goes to put his headphones back on, but hears an odd noise coming from a vent above one of the stalls.

DALE(CONT'D)
Now, what on earth could that be?

He drops the mop and climbs up on the toilet to peer into the vent. His eyes WIDEN.

DALE(CONT'D)
.... My God.

"Hey there, Franky. I see you're right on schedule for that 12:50 dump. Keep up that fiber intake, buddy!" Franky leaves. The janitor hears something. "What the hell?" He stands on top of a toilet bowl and looks into a vent. "My god".

INT. PETEY POSSUMS - DAY

Jack stands around the corner from Petey Possums. A MOTHER and CHILD come out and walk by Jack.

JACK
Hey, how's it goin'. Noticed you
walked out of there empty-handed.
Urgh, that's too bad. They rob you in

there, huh? Buncha greedy bastards.
One thousand tickets for a friggin'
finger puppet.

MOTHER
(to child)
Walk a little faster, sweetie.

The Mother and child speed walk past him. Jack looks over and sees Victor turn the corner dressed in overalls and wearing a propeller hat.

JACK
(to himself)
Oh, Jesus Christ.

Victor waves with a stupid grin on his face as he walks toward Jack.

JACK(CONT'D)
What is this? What are you doing?

VICTOR
Hey, Mr. Griffin! I figured I'd do my
best to dress the part.

JACK
I can't believe your Mother let you
walk out of the house like this.
Although she does let you wear those
sweaters in public... all your missing
is a giant swirly lollipop.

Victor pulls one out of his back pocket.

VICTOR
(proudly)
Brought one just in case.

Jack's visibly annoyed.

JACK
You know what, whatever. Let's just
get this over with.

INT. PETEY POSSUMS - DAY

Jack and Victor walk in. The place is running rampant with children. A bunch cough and sneeze their way through the jungle gym. In the birthday corner, children throw pizza at their parents as a person dressed as Petey Possum gets kicked

in the groin.

JACK
Alright, stay close, Vic. Don't want
these little animals to smell your
fear.

A SECURITY GUARD walks up to them.

SECURITY GUARD
You again? I told yo--

JACK
Oh, hello.

Jack puts Victor in front of him.

JACK(CONT'D)
As you can see, I have brought my
nephew here to play a few rounds of
ski ball and eat some mediocre pizza.

Victor grins. The Security Guard studies them. He leans
toward Victor.

SECURITY GUARD
(whispering)
If this man kidnapped you, just blink
once.

Victor's eyes widen, but then blinks frantically.

SECURITY GUARD(CONT'D)
I thought so!

VICTOR
What?! No! I have CDE!

SECURITY GUARD
CDE?

JACK
Chronic dry eyes. Kid practically
bathes in Visine.

The guard squints.

SECURITY GUARD
Fine... but I'm watching you two.

He walks away. Jack looks toward the counter.

JACK(CONT'D)

Now that the ogre is out of the way,
let's go buy that possum and get out
of here.

VICTOR

Wh-- We're not going to play any
games?

Jack ignores him and walks away. Victor SIGHS, hangs his head
and follows. Jack stops and stares at the stuffed possum. It
hangs on the top rack with specks of dust and grime. On it is
a sign that reads "10,000 Tickets" A CLERK walks behind the
counter.

CLERK

Hello! Welcome to Petey Possums. Where
the games are zany and the food is
grainy--

JACK

--Well, that's not the best tag line--

CLERK

--How can I help you?

JACK

Hi, uh. I was hoping to acquire that
red possum up there.

CLERK

Woah! Congrats! I didn't think it was
possible to win that. I'll need your
ten thousand tickets.

JACK

Actually, I was hoping to just buy him
straight up. Cut out the middle man,
yanno?

CLERK

Sorry, sir. I can't do that. That's
against the triple P.

JACK

The what?

VICTOR

Petey Possum Policy.

JACK

Oh, come on, man. Throw me a bone, here. My nephew is dying to get that Possum, but as you can see, he's not very coordinated.

Victor makes a face.

CLERK

No can do, sir. When I took this job, I took an oath to abide by the laws of the possum. What I can do is offer you a special discount that'll get you ten free coins when you buy a large pizza.

JACK

(frustrated)

Listen here, you little twerp. I didn't come here for your disgusting pizza. I came here to get that stuffed animal. I will be leaving with that possum whether I pay for him or not. The choice is yours.

The clerk stares at him.

CUT TO:

EXT. OUTSIDE PETEY POSSUMS - CONTINUOUS

Jack is forcefully brought out of Petey Possums by the security guard.

JACK

I want that god damn possum! I'll get it if it's the last thing I do!

Jack brings Victor to Petey Possums. Victor dresses like a child with a hat with the propeller on top. "What the hell is this?" "I wanted to sell the part" "This is so extreme. The only thing your missing is a giant swirly lollipop." Victor pulls one from his back pocket "Brought one just in case". "Good god. You know what, whatever. Let's just go in." OR "I can't believe I'm saying this, but you should have just stuck with one of your sweaters. Whatever. Let's just go in" They walk in and Jack addresses the bouncer. "Oh, hello. As you can see, I have brought my nephew here to play a few rounds of ski ball and eat some mediocre pizza." The bouncer studies him and whispers into Victor's ear. "If this man kidnapped

you. Just say CODE WORD FUNNY" "Um. No. This is my uncie jack jack." Jack looks at him, confused. "Alright... but I'm watching you guys." "Uncie jack jack?" "He bought it!" They walk up to the counter. "There it is. The pride of Petey Possums." The clerk walks up to them. "Welcome to Petey Possums. Where the games are zany and the food is grainy" "That's not a great tag line" "How can I help you". "Yes, hi, How many tickets would I need to get that big guy behind you? The clerk turns around. "10,000 tickets, sir." "10,000 tickets? That's ridiculous. What if I just paid for him. How much?" "He's not for sale, sir. We have a strict policy that you have to win the prizes." "Oh, come on. Everything has a price tag on it." "Not around here." Jack gets frustrated. "Listen here, you little twerp. I'm leaving with this stuffed animal whether I pay for it or not. The choice is yours." Silence for a moment. "I can offer you a special discount on coins this afternoo--" Jack snaps and tries to jump over the counter. He goes up to the counter and offers to buy the stuffed animal. It's not for sale. He snaps and then gets kicked out of Petey Possums permanently.

ACT TWO

INT. TEACHERS LOUNGE - DAY

Mary and Stef sit at the table with their lunches before them. Michelle quickly plops down on one of the seats, nearly knocking the table over.

MARY

Geez, Michelle. What's got you all wound up? You nearly knocked over my crudite.

STEF

Girl, that is a plate of vegetables. Just because you watch that French cooking show doesn't mean your sophisticated.

Mary shrugs it off.

MICHELLE

Sorry. Got this new espresso machine at home. Didn't realize how strong it was. Little jittery. My heart is just like...

She SCREAMS. Mary and Stef pull back.

MICHELLE

Anyway. I'm not just amped up from the 400 grams of caffeine flowing through my veins. I also have some news on Project "Get Durbin Laid".

STEF

We should really reconsider that name.

MARY

(to Stef)

Shh!

(to Michelle)

Spill!

MICHELLE

An old friend of mine just moved back here from Cleveland. She had a job out there that wasn't going well. Couldn't afford the housing an--

STEF

--Girl, focus!

MICHELLE

Right. Sorry. Anyways. She's been back for a few months now and I saw on her facebook that she went from "It's complicated" to "Single".

Mary and Stef give a look of concern.

STEF

Are we sure we should be setting Durbin up with a woman who actually used that option?

MARY

Yea, that screams "I'm divorced, but still stare at the tan line where my ring used to be."

MICHELLE

I think we should give it a shot! I mean, what else is he working with? It's not like he doesn't have some weird skeletons in his closet.

They look over at Durbin who's slightly grooving along to something on his headphones as he pours himself a cup of coffee.

STEF
Good point.

MICHELLE
Great.
(to Durbin)
HEY RALPH!

The girls JUMP. Durbin whips around, spilling his coffee on his shirt.

DURBIN
God!

He attempts to clean himself off, but accepts his misfortune and walks over to them.

DURBIN(CONT'D)
What is it, Michelle? You interrupted
Durbin Dancing time.

The teachers found a woman for durbin. One of the teachers good friends. "Guys! I think I found someone." "Who?" "My friend Martha. She's perfect. She just moved back here from Cleveland. Which means she's desperate and has no idea who he is." They call him over. They set him up and tell Durbin about it. He's all excited.

WHATEVER THE C RUNNER IS

Dale comes into the teacher's lounge in a huff.

DALE
Hey, uh. Sorry to bother you guys, but
I need to speak with principle Durbin.

MARY
Not now, Dale! We're hookin' Ralph up.
Go be a weirdo somewhere else.

DALE
Huh. Ouch. I'm just gonna. Move past
that.
(to Durbin)
I thought you might want to know that
there's a critter loose in the vents.

STEF
Isn't it your job to handle that sort

of stuff?

DALE

I tried to get it out yesterday,
but...

He shows the table a large mutilated gash on his right arm.
Everyone looks disgusted.

DURBIN

Right. Well, I appreciate you trying
ladies, but... I'm a principle first.
Duty calls!

DALE

Please don't say that word around me.

Durbin and Dale head towards the exit.

HELEN

Wait, Ralph.

He turns around.

HELEN(CONT'D)

You're always putting this schools
needs before your own. It's time
someone else steps up to the plate.
You... deserve to find love.

DURBIN

Helen... I. I don't know what to say.
Are you sure you can handle this?

HELEN

Oh, yea. I once took on a hoard of
racoons during a family camping trip.
My brother lost an eye, but we roasted
mallows and sang tunes without any
fear that night. Nothin' I can't
handle.

Helen walks out.

DALE

I was going to suggest we just call
animal control. This, uh. Works too...
I guess.

"Sorry to bother you guys, but I need to speak with Principle
durbin. There's a critter loose in the vents. I tried to get

it out yesterday... and well." He shows them the giant gash on his arm. "Well. I appreciate the concern ladies, but duty calls." "Please don't say that around me." "No! C'mon, Ralph! You're always spending so much time on this school. You never get a chance to yourself." "She's right, Ralph." - Helen. "You deserve to find love." "Are you sure?" "Oh, yea. I once took on a hoard of raccoons during a family camping trip. My brother lost an eye, but we took them down. Nothing I can't handle" She walks away. "I was going to say we should call animal control, but... this works too, I guess."

INT. CLASSROOM - DAY

Jack sits at his desk rubbing his temples with his head kicked back.

JACK
Well, guys. My plan with Victor completely failed.
(to Victor)
Thanks for nothing, Vic.

Victor looks down, defeated. Jack gets up and grabs some chalk. He tosses it up and down in his hand.

JACK(CONT'D)
So we need a new tactic. Let's put our heads together and see if we can figure out a way to get me that damn possum.

MARCUS
Don't you think this is a little much?
I mean... it's a stuffed animal.

JACK
No, Marcus. I don't think it's
(sarcastic voice)
A little much.

Jack snaps his fingers and points down. Marcus hesitates. Jack clenches his teeth and gives him a "I swear to god" Type of look. Marcus puts his head down.

HEATHER
What if we all went, boss?

JACK
Huh. I'm listening.

HEATHER

Well. There's 12 of us. If each one of us wins around 835 tickets, we could combine them to get that possum for you.

JACK

See. This is the initiative that we need around here, guys. Heather just saved you all from that F I was planning on giving you.

Heather blushes. Everyone groans.

JACK(CONT'D)

Eh eh eh. I won't have any of that. She might have saved you all from that F I was planning on giving you. Now, Heather. Seeing that I'm officially banned from Petey Possums. How would you like to be my eyes and ears?

HEATHER

You bet your ass.

"Well, guys. My plan with Victor completely failed. Thanks for nothing Vic" Victor looks defeated. "Now I'm banned from Petey Possums permanently. He tells them what happened with Victor and how he failed to get the stuffed animal. "You don't think this is a little...childish?" Marcus. "I don't, Marcus. Head down." Marcus hesitates. Jack clenches his jaw. He puts his head down. " Now. New plan. All of you are going to Petey Possums to win 10,000 tickets or--" "We get an F" - Everyone. "See. Now you're getting it. Heather." "Yea, Boss?" "Being that I'm officially banned, I need you to be my eyes and ears. You up for the job?" "You bet your ass".

INT. BATHROOM - DAY

Helen and Dale stand on a toilet seat. They peer through the vent with flash lights.

HELEN

You sure you didn't just hallucinate?
The fumes that are being produced in here are pungent.

DALE

You're tellin' me. I soak this place with clorox spray every morning... but no... No, it's in there somewhere.

Just waiting for its chance to strike.

HELEN

We could try smoking her out. I keep my portable smoker in my desk incase I want to add some hickory flavor without the kalori--

DALE

--Shh! Did you hear that?

HELEN

Sorry. Might've been me. All that smoked beef talk got my tummy rumblin'.

Dale's eyes WIDEN.

DALE

No. Look.

Two red eyes stare right back at them.

HELEN

There's the little rascal. C'mere you!

Helen sticks her hand in the vent.

The janitor and Helen have flashlights in the vents. "You sure you didn't imagine it? The fumes being produced in here are... just awful" "No, it's in there somewhere. Waiting for the chance to strike". "Maybe we should smoke her out. I keep my portable smoker in my desk just in case I need to add some hickory flavor without the kalori--" "Shh! Did you hear that?!" "Sorry. Might've been me. All that smoked beef talk got my tummy rumblin'" "No... look" Two red eyes stare back at them" "There's the little rascal. C'mon you!" Helen sticks her hands in the vent.

INT. PETEY POSSUMS - DAY

The front display has a security camera picture of jack freaking out with a sign on top saying BANNED. The students walk past the guard. They all nod and smile. Heather walks in last.

HEATHER

Hey there, big fella. Don't mind us. Just a bunch of kids lookin' to get their ski ball fix in.

The security guard looks around, confused.

SECURITY GUARD
Uh. Alright. Enjoy.

She walks over to the ball pit, pulls out an empty sack, and puts her finger on her ear.

HEATHER
We're in.

"Hey there, big fella. Don't mind us. Just a bunch of kids lookin' to get their game fix in." "Uh. Alright. Enjoy". She walks and holds a finger on her ear. "We're in"

EXT. OUTSIDE OF PETEY POSSUMS - DAY

Jack sits in the drivers Ed car with sunglasses, a hat, and a pair of binoculars.

JACK
Good. That possum is as good as mine.

Jack takes a hunk out of an apple and grins.

"Good. That possum is as good as ours."

INT. BAR - NIGHT

Durbin sits at a table wearing a suit jacket and a bolo tie. His blind date MARTHA approaches.

MARTHA
Hi. Sorry, are you Ralph Durbin by any chance?

DURBIN
Hello! You must be Martha. Yes. I uh.
I am the Ralph you speak of.
(chuckles)
Here, have a seat.

Martha CHUCKLES and grabs her chair.

DURBIN(CONT'D)
WAIT!

Martha JUMPS.

DURBIN(CONT'D)
Sorry. I'm such a buffoon! Where are

my manners?

Durbin gets up and pulls the chair out an inch more.

MARTHA

Th-thank you.

Ralph sits back down.

MARTHA(CONT'D)

So. Um. I'm glad we were able to get together. Michelle told me so much about you.

DURBIN

(chuckles)

Hopefully not the bad stuff.

Martha LAUGHS.

DURBIN(CONT'D)

No, seriously. She didn't tell you about the ____ incident, did she? I knew she couldn't keep a secret. Last time I confide in her.

MARTHA

No. All... all good things.

DURBIN

Oh. Then forget I said anything. Where's my official MIB mind eraser when you need it, right?

Durbin LAUGHS. Martha looks uneasy.

DURBIN(CONT'D)

Signed by the guy who voiced one of the aliens, might I add.

"Ralph?" "Oh, hello there. You must be Martha! Have a seat" "Thanks, Michelle told me so much about you" "Heh, hopefully not the bad stuff" She laughs. "No, seriously, did she tell you about the____?? I knew I shouldn't have mentioned anything to her" "No... All good things" "Oh" chuckles "well, then forget I said anything."

CUT TO:

Different scenes of him saying absurd things.

INT. PETEY POSSUMS - DAY

Each of the students are tasked with a different game. After accumulating a handful of tickets, they walk over to the ballpit, pull out a sack of tickets, shove their share in and get back to work.

Heather has a birds eye view of the operation as she watches through a bubble window in the jungle gym. Jack talks into her ear.

JACK(O.S)
How are we lookin', Heather?

HEATHER
Like a _____ on prom night - **think of
joke.**

JACK(O.S)
That's... good. Keep me updated.

Heather sees the Petey Possums clerk keeping an eye on Marcus who just made his way over to the ball pit.

HEATHER
Uh oh.

JACK(O.S)
What?

The clerk walks over to Marcus. Hand gestures galore. Marcus throws his hands up and points to the ball pit. The clerk looks in that direction.

HEATHER
We've got a problem. Marcus has been breached!

JACK(O.S)
Gah! Marcus! Of course! Who else!

HEATHER
We have to abort! The jig is up! The sack has been discovered!

Heather shimmies her way over to the slide.

All of the kids are doing their jobs. Heather lets Jack know that they're almost at the total number (10,000). The counter worker notices something's up. He see's that all of them are stashing tickets in a secret spot. He confronts the person

who just came from the secret spot. Heather lets Jack know. "We have to abort. We've been spotted! I repeat, we've been spotted!"

EXT. OUTSIDE OF PETEY POSSUMS - DAY

Jack gets restless in the car.

JACK

Do not! I repeat, do not let that cretin take those tickets.

HEATHER(O.S)

Now Victor is trying to take the bag away from the clerk!

JACK

God dammit! Victor has zero upper body strength.

Jack looks through the binoculars then looks around.

JACK(CONT'D)

Alright. I'm going to come in and try to take the heat off of you guys.

Jack gets out of the car.

JACK(CONT'D)

If that doesn't work, then I give you permission to take that Possum loving creep out. I've waited too long to get my hands on that stuffed animal. I refuse to leave without it.

As Jack reaches the door, a TIRED MOM drags her NAGGING CHILD out of Petey Possums.

NAGGING CHILD

No! No! I DON'T WANT TO LEAVE YET!

TIRED MOM

Mommy needs to get home so she can self medicate.

NAGGING CHILD

Leave without me! I almost had enough for the Chinese finger traps!

Jack analyzes the situation. He takes a look at the scene outside and then through the glass window. Victor and Marcus

are in a tug of war with the clerk. Tickets fly through the air. A drunk Dad laughs with a slice of pizza in his hand. Jack then sees himself in the windows reflection. He SIGHS and slowly raises the walkie up.

JACK

Heather. It's alright... tell the guys
to abort the mission.

HEATHER

Wh- Are you sure, boss? I've got a
clear shot.

JACK

I'm sure. Take whatever tickets you
have and get a... Chinese finger trap.

Jack tells her not to abort the mission. They've made it this far. "I want that stuffed animal and I refuse to leave here until I get it!" "He's trying to take the bag away from Victor!" "God dammit! Victor has zero upper body strength. I'm going to come in as a distraction. If that doesn't work, you have my permission to take him out" He gets out of the car and he's about to walk in, but a little kid comes out with his Mom screaming and crying "I want it! I want it! I want it!". Jack realizes how childish he's being. He tells Heather to abort the mission. "Are you sure, boss? I think I can take him" "I'm sure. Get whatever you can with the tickets you have".

INT. PETEY POSSUMS - DAY

Heather takes her finger off of her ear. In her other hand, she holds a torn-out wack-a-mole mallet. She stares at the cashier.

HEATHER

Count your blessings, Petey.

ACT THREE

INT. TEACHERS LOUNGE - DAY

The teachers get snacks by the vending machine.

MICHELLE

--and then he showed her pictures of
his lightsaber collection.

STEF
(chuckles)
That's wild.

MICHELLE
I know! I didn't think they were even
real.

Durbin walks in. The teachers act inconspicuous.

MARY
Hey, Ralph. Uh, so, how'd it go?

DURBIN
Oh, it was wonderful- HE GOES OFF ON
SOMETHING RANDOM.

The teachers look at him, confused.

DURBIN(CONT'D)
Oh. Oh! You meant the date. No, that
went horribly awry.
(To Michelle)
You never mentioned she was allergic
to mussels and clams.

MICHELLE
I... didn't realize that it was a deal
breaker.

DURBIN
Psh, well, my diet is about eighty
percent shellfish, so... that wasn't
going to work for me.

MICHELLE
What's the other twenty percent?

STEF
Who cares.
(to Durbin)
Sorry it didn't work out, Ralph. We'll
keep on trying. You'll find that
special someone.

DURBIN
Y'know ladies, I appreciate the
concern, but... If I learned anything
from last night, it's that I'm pretty
content with being on my own. After
the date, I went home to the ol'

bachelor pad. Kicked off my shoes and let them land wherever they pleased. Cooked up some leftovers, watched THINK OF A SHOW, had a good cry, and crashed on my couch.

MARY

That sounds... kinda sad.

DURBIN

Yea. Yea, I guess it does. Well, y'know what the Japanese say. Tueachizzone.

He bows. The teachers look at each other, but shrug it off.

DURBIN(CONT'D)

By the way, have any of you guys seen Helen? She wasn't at her desk this morning.

date amongst themselves. Repeating some of the stuff that he said that was passed on from one of their friends. Durbin comes in. They ask how it went. He says he had a great night and goes into detail about some of it. They're confused. "Oh, you mean the date! No, That went horribly wrong. She's allergic to shellfish which means she wouldn't get to enjoy my clams durbin. OR which is a big red flag for me. I basically live on the stuff" He doesn't acknowledge that he might have been the weird one. "Thanks for thinking of me guys, but I'm perfectly fine being single. Whenever that special someone comes my way, then I'll be ready. I don't like to force things. Now, if you'll excuse me, I have to (reference to something that he did or found the night before. OR he could have even met another woman while his date hopped out of the window.

INT. BATHROOM - DAY

Helen and Dale stand on stop of the bathroom sinks. They're covered in scratches. They cower in fear at a GIANT POSSUM sniffing around the bathroom stalls.

DALE

What happened to all of that talk about taking out a hoard of raccoons?

HELEN

Those things were normal sized. This. This here is a mutant!

DALE
I knew we should have just called
animal control.

HELEN
You know what? No. We are higher up on
the food chain than this beast. He is
one and we are many! Let's take him
on!

Dale gets pumped up.

DALE
Yea!

HELEN
Plus, I gotta get out of this
bathroom. My eyes might be bleeding
from the stench.

INT. CLASSROOM - DAY

Jack gloomily walks into the classroom leaving the door open
behind him.

JACK
(sighs)
Alright, guys. Uh. Let's just put our
heads down an--

He notices all of the students seem chipper. They're looking
towards his desk.

JACK(CONT'D)
Wh-

Jack looks over in that direction. On top of his desk lays
the giant red possum. Jack brightens up. He walks over to it.

JACK(CONT'D)
How did you guys? Did you guys go back
and win it?

They all shake their heads.

HEATHER
It was on your desk when we walked in.

Jack studies the possum. He sees a note on it's arm.

ON THE SCREEN:

Turns out, the Triple P takes a side seat when you flash a little side boob.

- Lynette

BACK TO JACK

He smiles and places the note on his desk. He sits at his desk as he stares.

VICTOR
Who's it from?

JACK
Uhh. Mind your business, Vic.

Jack picks it up, studies it, then gives it a big hug.

SARIKA
Wow. This is actually kind of swee--

Jack LAUGHS maniacally.

JACK
Screw you, Dad! You selfish piece of crap! I finally won it! Who's the loser now!

SARIKA
And we're back.

Suddenly, an ACTUAL possum scurries into the room.

VICTOR
Ahhh! It's Petey Possum coming for revenge!

The students freak out. Standing on desks and running to the back of the room. Helen and Dale run in. They're covered in scratches. Dale's carrying a cartoonishly large fish net.

HELEN
There's the little bastard!

DALE
We have to corner him!

They pursue the possum. The students continue to SCATTER and SCREAM.

Amidst all of the chaos, Jack sits at his desk unphazed. He

stares at the stuffed animal with a large grin. He finally got it.

and finds the stuffed animal on his desk looking brand new. "How. How did you guys--" "Don't worry about it, boss. I told you we wouldn't let you down." "Wow. This is. The best birthday present I've ever received". As Jack admires the stuffed animal, someone whispers to heather "Are you going to let him know that you got it at Walmart?" She looks over at how happy he is. "Nah. I think the moment is more important than the actual stuffed animal" Jack laughs maniacally. "Screw you, Dad, you selfish piece of crap! I finally won it! Who's the loser now!!"